had won what became its War of Independence, and the Nakba ("catastrophe") for the Palestinians.

The 1948–49 war ended, among other things, with Israel controlling somewhat more than half the territory allocated to it in the 1947 partition plan and with hundreds of thousands of Palestinian refugees, who had fled in terror after a string of massacres or after being driven away by the Israeli army on orders from above. An uneasy armistice took hold with, over time, incursions by Palestinian infiltrators and growing Israeli reprisals. In October 1956 a brief war took place between Israel, France, and Great Britain against Gamal Abdel Nasser's Egypt. The obvious victory of these three strange bedfellows was annulled by threats from the Soviet Union and an angry reaction from the US president, Dwight Eisenhower.

## *Monday, January 23*

A fundamental and dramatic change occurred in June 1967 with the stunning Israeli victory in the Six-Day War and the occupation of the Gaza Strip, the Sinai Peninsula, the whole of the West Bank of the Jordan, the Golan Heights, and, of course, the whole of Jerusalem. Most Israelis considered this a miracle, and some heard the "steps of the Messiah" (*paamei hamashiach*). Some, very few, were wary of the consequences, and Zalman Aran, the minister of education in Levi Eshkol's cabinet, famously asked: "Wie kriecht man heraus?" (How does one crawl out?). President Lyndon Johnson didn't demand the evacuation of the Occupied Territories. In the Khartoum Resolution of September 1,1967, the Arab states proclaimed that there would be no negotiations and no peace with Israel. Thus, the existing situation solidified and the first settlements followed: Gush Etzion and several so-called military outposts. Even Eshkol, a socialist prime minister, could not resist the pressure coming from the right. Or, did he welcome it?